INTERVIEW PREPARATION

Harley — Regenerative Garden Systems

Meeting with Eric Haas
Primal Nature Retreats

Tomorrow at 17:00

"I build regenerative garden environments that help retreat centers create deeper nature-based healing experiences."

1. Core Identity

Remember: You are not asking for a job. You are offering a contribution.

Key Phrase:

"I like building systems where nature does most of the work."

2. Your Story (Short Version)

1. Grew up helping with dad's landscaping business
2. Got interested in growing food
3. Discovered permaculture and passive irrigation
4. Started experimenting with regenerative systems

Important: Do NOT oversell. Be curious. Frame everything as experiments and ideas.

Example phrase: "I've been experimenting with..."

3. Olla Irrigation Explanation (Simple)

"You bury a porous clay pot in the soil. When the soil dries, it pulls water through the clay. So the plant basically waters itself."

Benefits to mention:

- ~60-70% water savings (University of Arizona)
- No electricity required
- Extremely low maintenance
- Cheaper than drip irrigation

4. The Integration Bridge — Your Strongest Angle

This is your most powerful connection to Eric's work:

"I noticed that gardening and nature time are often recommended for psychedelic integration. That made me think gardens could actually be part of the healing environment."

Scientific backing:

• The MAPS Integration Workbook specifically recommends gardening as an integration practice

• Horticultural therapy is proven to reduce depression and anxiety

• Nature interaction improves emotional processing

5. Value Proposition

Full version:

"I build regenerative garden environments that help retreat centers create deeper nature-based healing experiences."

Shorter version:

"I build garden systems where nature supports healing."

6. Questions to Ask Eric

These questions matter a lot — they show genuine interest:

1. How much of the retreat experience happens outdoors?

2. Do guests interact with the land much?

3. Is growing food something you've thought about doing more here?

4. What are the biggest challenges running retreats?

5. What kind of long-term vision do you have for the place?

7. Emergency Phrases (If You Get Stuck)

Situation	Phrase
Conversation stalls	"I'm curious how you see the land evolving over the next few years."
Don't know the answer	"That's a great question — I'd need to experiment with that."
Talked too much	"But I'd love to hear how you approach that."
Things feel awkward	"I'm still learning a lot, but I really enjoy working with natural systems."

8. Handling Objections

Objection: "We don't have budget for a garden."

Response: "That's actually why I focus on low-maintenance systems. The idea is to start small and let the system grow over time."

Objection: "We don't need more staff."

Response: "Totally understandable. I'm mainly looking for a place where I can contribute and learn — even starting small."

Objection: "What's in it for you?"

Response: "I'm looking for a community where I can work with land and build meaningful projects."

9. Integration Garden — Key Plants

Only mention a few plants. Too many sounds theoretical.

Plant	Benefits	Connection
Lavender	Reduces anxiety, calming fragrance	Guests can smell plants while walking
Chamomile	Relaxation, sleep support	Fresh tea for integration evenings
Lemon Balm	Reduces stress, mood support	Gentle herb for nervous system
Mint	Refreshing, stimulates senses	Sensory stimulation and fresh tea
Rosemary	Improves cognitive clarity	Good for clarity after intense experiences

10. Bonus Idea: Barefoot Grounding Path

A short path where guests walk barefoot through different textures:

• Grass → Sand → Smooth stones → Wood chips

Purpose: Stimulates sensory nerves and promotes grounding. Used in ecotherapy, mindfulness retreats, and sensory therapy gardens.

This would be very memorable for retreat guests.

11. The Real Goal

The real goal of this interview is NOT the garden.

Eric is deciding: "Is this someone I want around my retreat?"

Be:

• Calm — speak slowly and thoughtfully

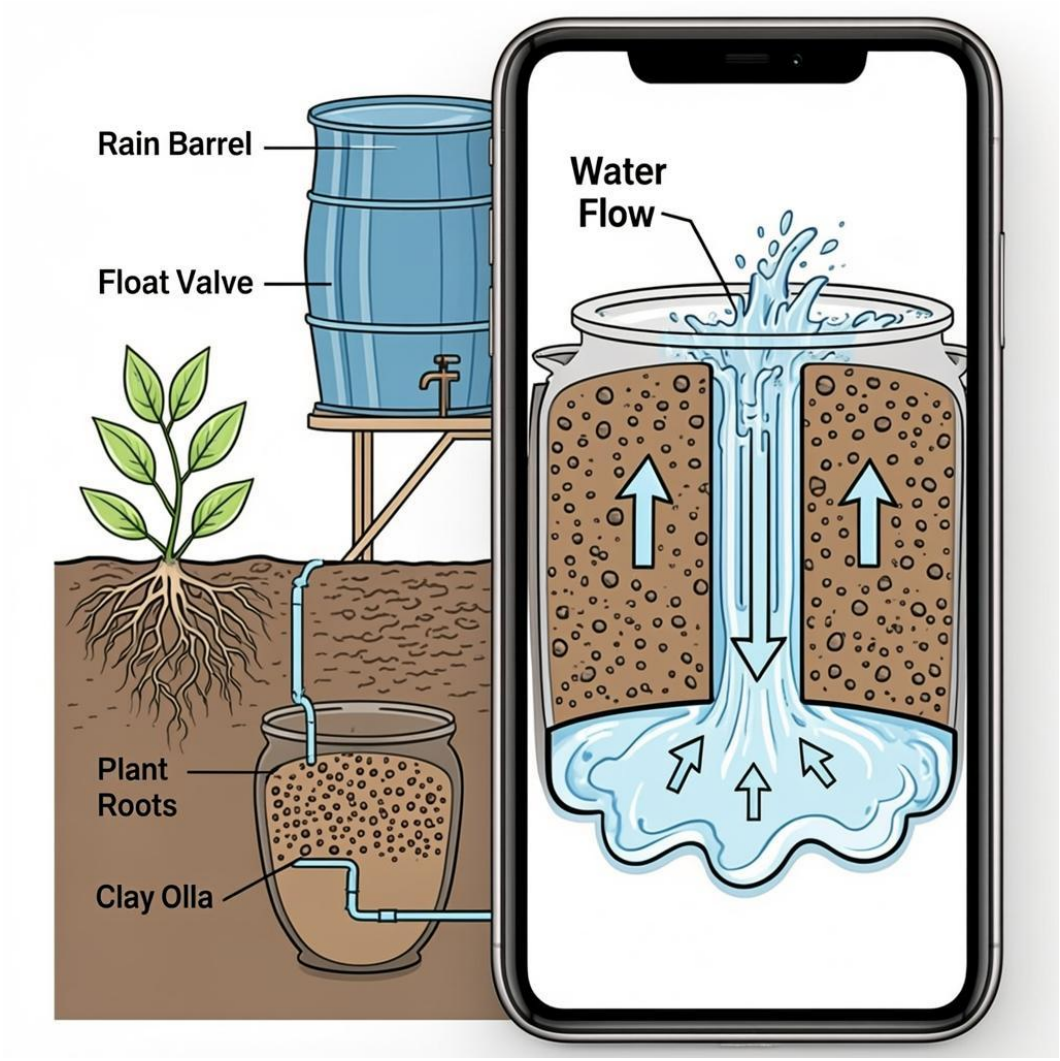
- Curious — ask genuine questions
- Humble — frame as experiments, not expertise
- Thoughtful — pause before answering

NOT: Overly ambitious, pushy, or selling too hard.

12. Visual Materials — Show on Phone

Olla Irrigation System Diagram

Show this to explain the passive water system:



Integration Garden Concept

Show this to visualize the retreat garden: